SOCIAL FINANCE

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Standards Development Working Group

24th February 2026

PRIVATE AND CONFIDENTIAL

Agenda

14:30 -14:40 (10m)	**Welcome and housekeeping** Andrew Newman, ODI
14:40 -14:55 (15m)	**Intro to ASC Joined up care** Juliette Clewlow, Social Finance
14:55 – 15:50 (55m)	**Data Model Deep Dive (Interactive Session)** Andrew Newman, ODI and Harry Angus, Social Finance
15:55 -16:00 (5m)	**Next Steps**

Things to be aware of

Conflicts of interest – Please inform the chair / secretariat if you think there is a risk.

Anti-competitive activities – Please inform the chair / secretariat if you think there is a risk of anti-competitive activity.

Intellectual Property - If you are concerned about the use of your contributions, please contact the secretariat.

Meeting Recording - We will record the meeting and using AI transcription tools.

Working together

1. Every voice matters
2. Please join in on the conversation, we don’t want this to be one way
3. If you’re happy to, keep your camera on
4. Please raise your hand if you want to come in, or drop your ideas in the chat
5. Respect the diverse viewpoints in the room, assume positive intent and remain open for different experiences
6. We will be using Miro to support our discussions today

News!

Receive our regular newsletter

Sign up at:
- http://eepurl.com/jnmjYs

Website: https://socialcaredata.github.io/ (start here!)

GitHub: https://github.com/SocialCareData

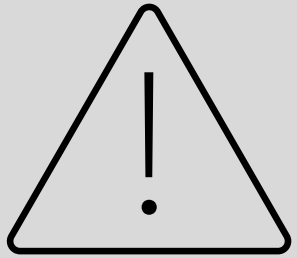
We are using GitHub to work openly:

- Store our specifications
- Track feedback on specifications (Issues)
- Openly share project documentation
- Have Discussions to inform the development of standards

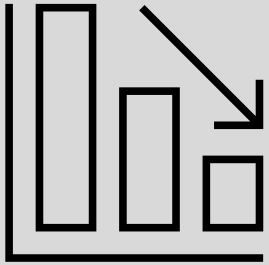
- In the future we will use GitHub to:
- Host and manage the development of any infrastructure or tools we need to develop
- Enable people to reuse our specifications and code

We will work to keep this simple and provide guidance when needed.

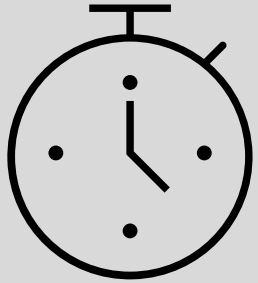
Last year we defined four key areas where we thought standards might benefit the social care system



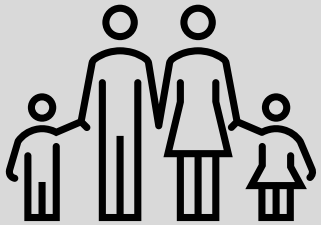
Improved data sharing to support frontline decision making



Better analysis to support strategic decision making



Access to productivity-enhancing tools for frontline staff



Enabling those using social care to see and contribute to their record

What we have worked on so far

Person	Data Exchange	Information Governance
A specification to standardise data required to distinguish one person from another	A FHIR-based API pattern to enable automated data exchange between organisations.	An information governance framework that can support automated machine-to-machine data sharing.
https://socialcaredata.github.io/spec/person	https://socialcaredata.github.io/spec/data-exchange	https://socialcaredata.github.io/spec/information-governance

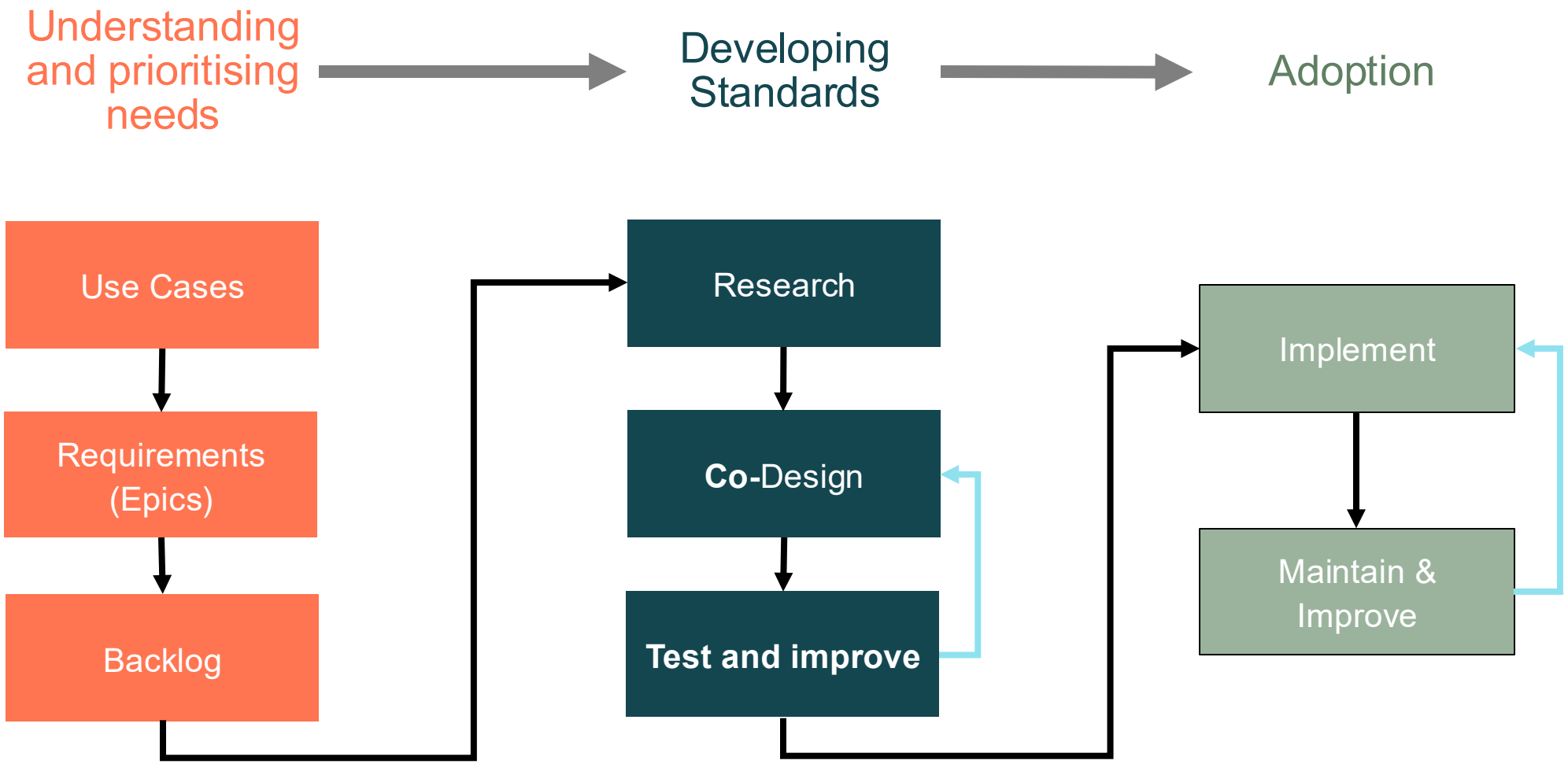
We may need to revisit and revise these as our work progresses.

We're working across four workstreams

Safeguarding and Wellbeing	Joined up care	Core technical standards	Placements
Creating standards which allow for more efficient and timely sharing of information between agencies to support safeguarding and wellbeing decisions, with a focus on children's social care	Creating standards which allow for more efficient and consistent recording and sharing of information to support joined up working in adult's social care	Creating cross-cutting technical standards which support a range of use cases	Creating a standard which described children's social care placements needs and costs to support regional sufficiency analysis

(Separate working group)

Standards Development Process



Joined up care (ASC)

Our research and prioritisation approach

We identified joined up working as an important improvement theme for adult social care

From engagement with the sector, we **identified a longlist of use cases** for ASC CMS standards

We **mapped the technical requirements** for these use cases, and the **benefits** they would bring and for whom

We wanted to prioritise the use cases that supported **improved safety and quality of care**, and **time saving for practitioners** and aligned with ASC national priorities

We **identified a shortlist of use cases** that supported better multi-agency information sharing for joined up care within ASC

linking closely with the existing multi-agency information sharing focus for CSC

Opportunities to improve joined up care

Shortlisted use cases looking at improved interoperability for better joined up adult social care

Multi-agency enquiries for assessment and review	Notifications from hospital to social care	Transitions from CSC to ASC	Recording and sharing assessments and plans
• Easily accessing information to complete a **care needs assessment** e.g. health/ mental health • Easily accessing information to **review a care plan** e.g. from care providers	• Enabling activity notifications to social workers of hospital **admissions and discharge**	• Adult social workers can receive, track and act on information about young people **transitioning from children's to adult's services** e.g. from CSC CMS record	• Standardising core parts of a **care needs assessment** and **care plan** to help share this with partners more easily

Next steps: We are continuing our engagement and will name the specific standards we will be working on by April 2026

What this means for our working group

We want to look at standards that support better sharing of key information between partners in adult social care e.g. *health, care providers, CSC*

Sharing adult social care data requires a lot of the **same core standards** as in children's social care e.g. identifying a person in a system, key social work terms

This working group gives us the opportunity to work on cross-social care standards in a joined-up way

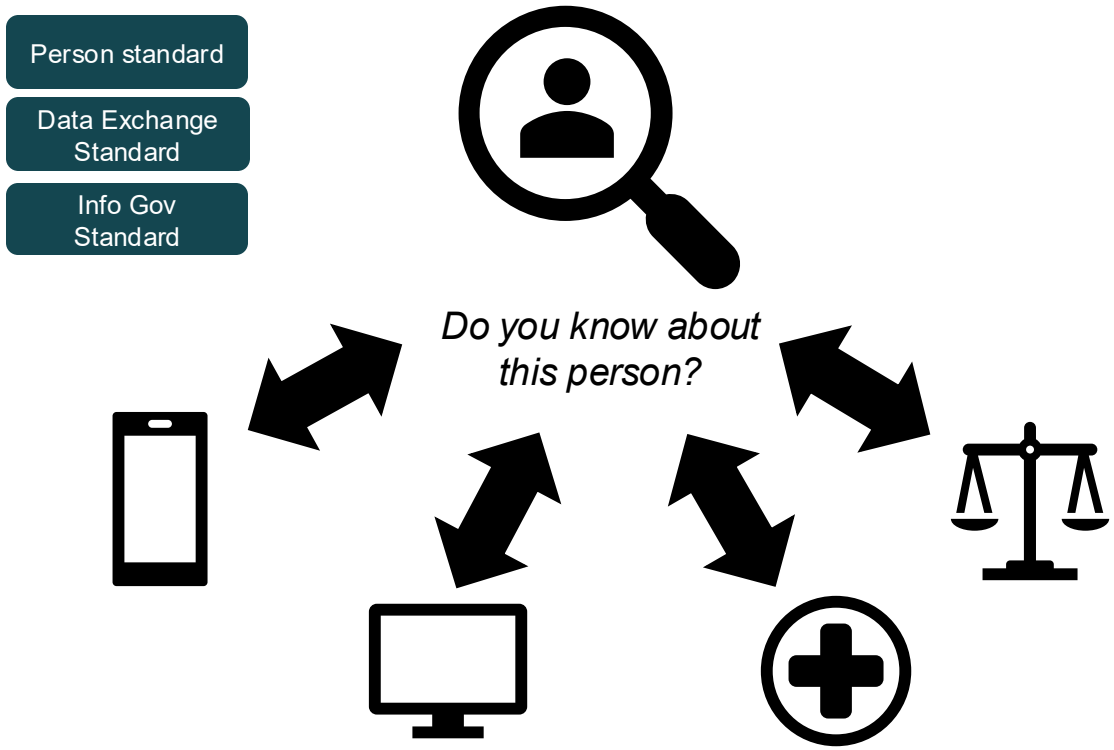
Note: we know there will be differences between CSC and ASC – where we need to separate, we will consider focused sessions.

Any questions?

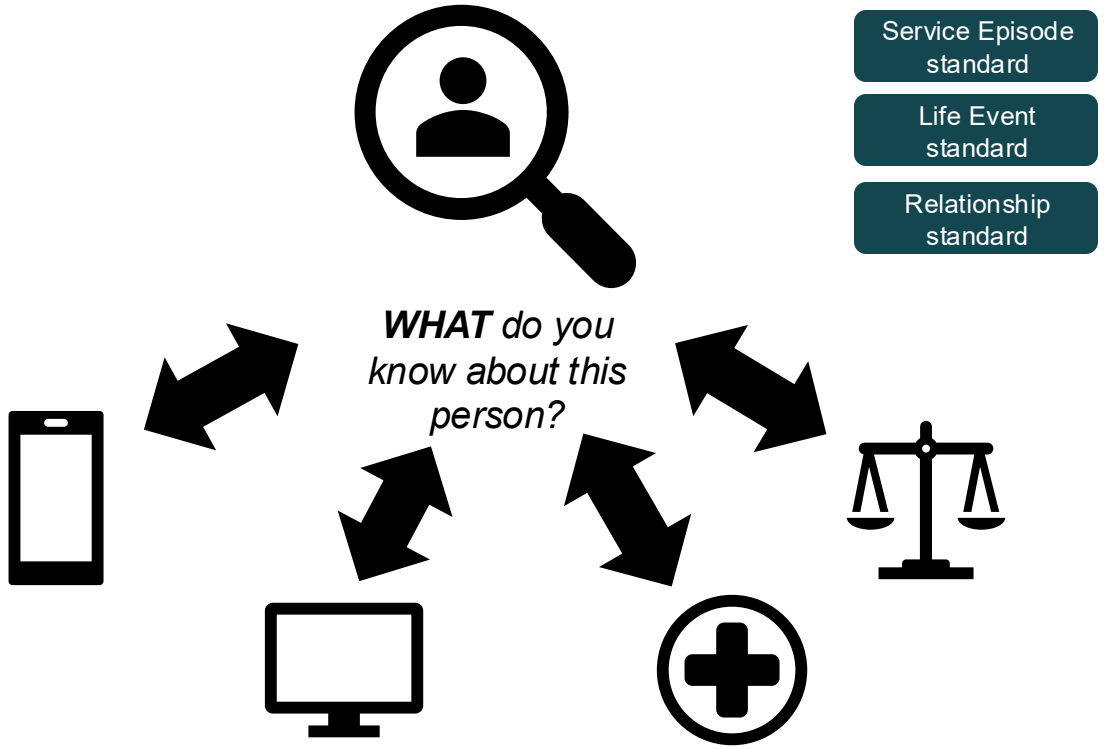
Data Model Deep Dive

We're branching out

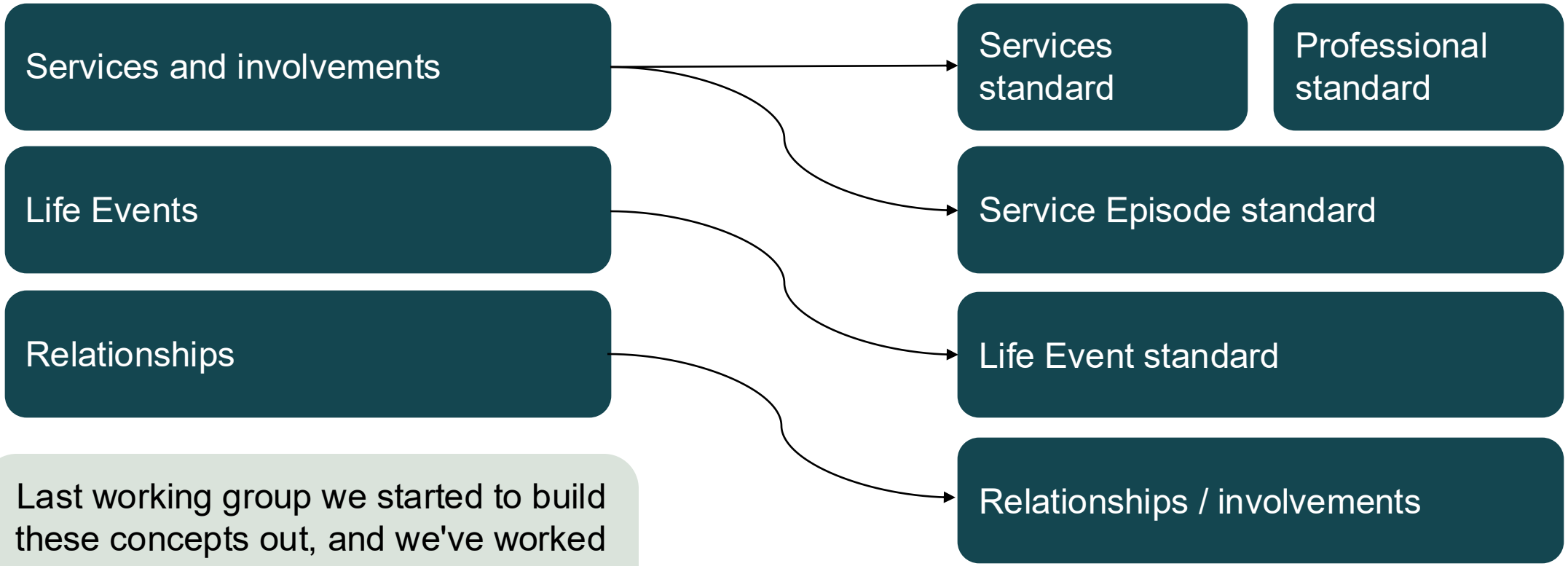
From sharing identification in MAIS scenarios...



… to sharing care information too.

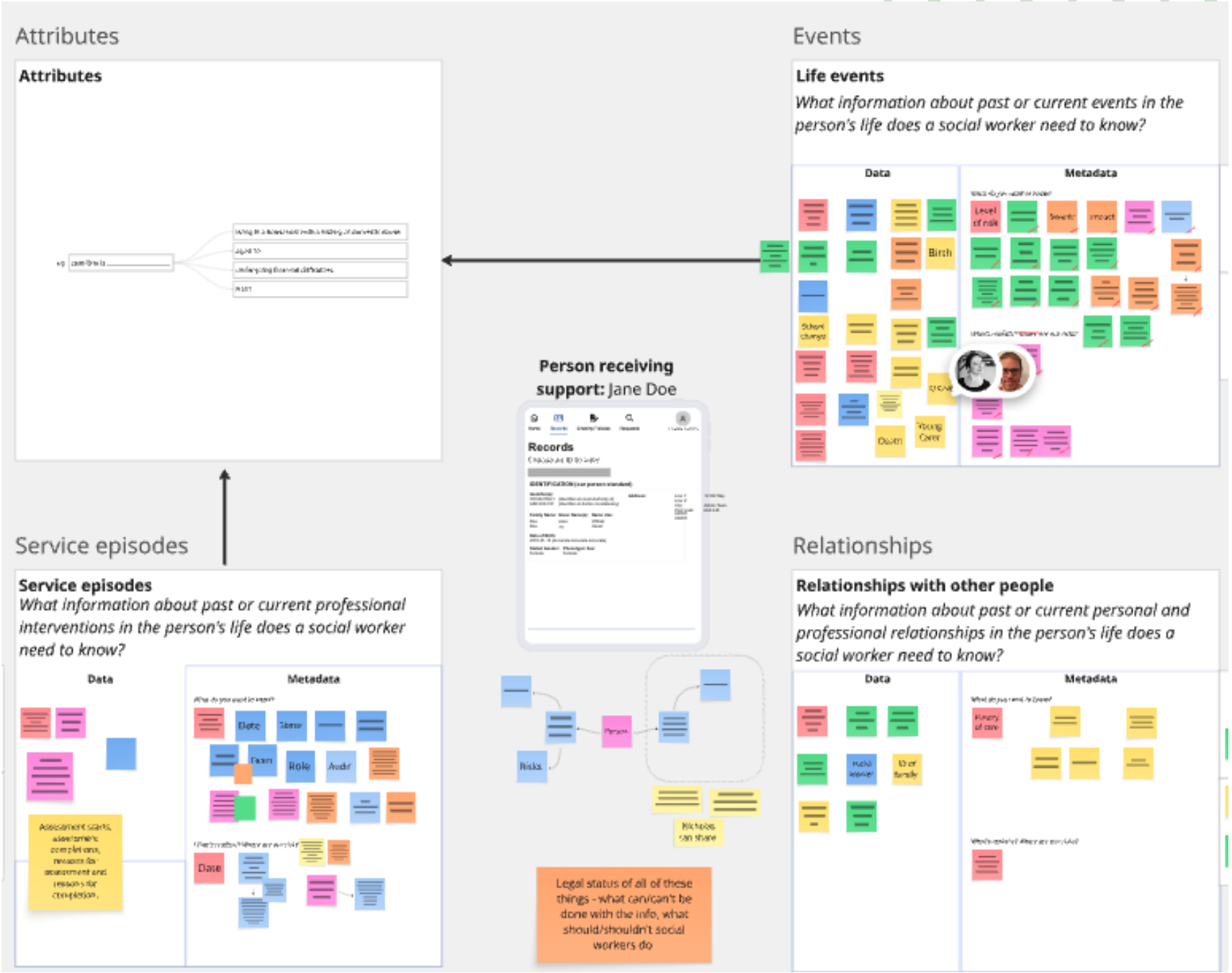


This demands common concepts across different systems:



Last working group we started to build these concepts out, and we've worked behind the scenes to turn them into data standards

Last time


Attributes
Attributes
Events
Life events
What information about past or current events in the person's life does a social worker need to know?
Data
Metadata
Birth
Person receiving support: Jane Doe
Records
Service episodes
Service episodes
What information about past or current professional interventions in the person's life does a social worker need to know?
Data
Metadata
Date
Role
Relationships
Relationships with other people
What information about past or current personal and professional relationships in the person's life does a social worker need to know?
Data
Metadata
Risks
Legal status of all of these things - what can/can't be done with the info, what should/shouldn't social workers do

We've been busy!

socialcaredata.github.io/spec

Services standard

Professional standard

Service Episode standard

Life Event standard

Relationship standard

Data Standards for Social Care

Use Cases Standards Working Groups Newsletter Specifications

This catalogue provides access to the data specifications being developed for social care case management systems.

The specifications are generated dynamically from the latest versions in GitHub.

As new specifications are developed they will be added to this catalogue.

Title
Person Data Standard (I
Logical Model
Life Event
Professional
Relationship
Service Episode

LifeEvent

The life event that has occurred.

Field name	Cardinality	Data Type	Description
LifeEvent.Identifier	1..*	Object	Unique identifiers (IDs) associated with the life event.
↳ LifeEvent.Identifier.value	1..1	String	A single unique identifier attached to the life event (e.g., ?).
↳ LifeEvent.Identifier.system	1..1	URI	System that the identifier adheres to (e.g., ?).
LifeEvent.Type	1..*	Code (EventCode)	Code for the type of the life event (e.g. birth, death).
LifeEvent.Risk	0..*	Code (RiskCode)	Code for the risk level of the life event (?).
LifeEvent.SubjectPerson	1..*	Object	References to Person(s) involved in the life event.
↳ LifeEvent.SubjectPerson.ref	1..1	Link	A reference to a Person record involved in the life event.
↳ LifeEvent.SubjectPerson.involvement	1..1	Code (PersonInvolvementCode)	Code for the nature of the Person's involvement in the life event.
LifeEvent.RelatedProfessional	0..*	Object	References to Professional(s) involved in the life event.
↳ LifeEvent.RelatedProfessional.ref	1..1	Link	A reference to a Professional record involved in the life event.
↳ LifeEvent.RelatedProfessional.involvement	1..1	Code (ProfessionalInvolvementCode)	Code for the nature of the Person's involvement in the life event.
LifeEvent.RelatedService	0..*	Object	References to Service(s) involved in the life event.
↳ LifeEvent.RelatedService.ref	1..1	Link	A reference to a Service record involved in the life event.
LifeEvent.TimeInformation	0..*	Object	Details about timing of the life event
↳ LifeEvent.TimeInformation.startDateTime	1..1	DateTime	DateTime (ISO-8601) for start of the life event.
↳ LifeEvent.TimeInformation.endDateTime	0..1	DateTime	DateTime (ISO-8601) for end of the life event.
↳ LifeEvent.TimeInformation.expectedFrequency	0..1	Code (FrequencyCode)	Expected frequency of the life event.
LifeEvent.LocationInformation	0..*	String	Details about the location of the life event

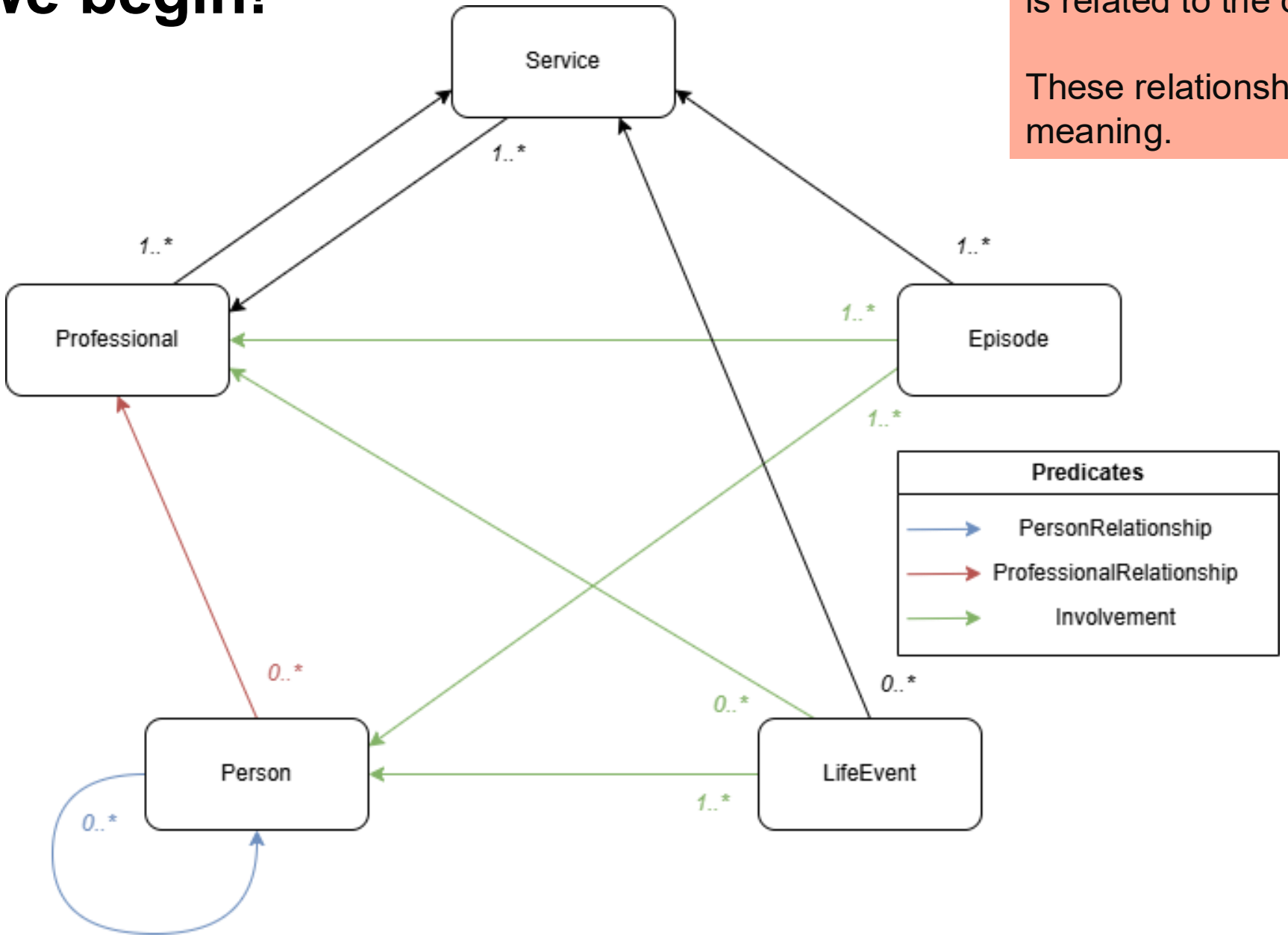
Today

- We'll walk you through an overview of our data model.
- We will then open a Miro Board to enable you to review and comment on the things we have added.
- We also have sone key questions where we need your opinions.
- If you have points/views outside of our questions, please share them! The questions are intended to be conversation starters.

Before we begin!

Each concept in our data model is related to the others.

These relationships have meaning.



Lets go to Miro

https://miro.com/app/board/uXjVG6ASXUo=/

Professional

A professional is an individual acting in a formal role within an organisation who has responsibilities relating to an individual's safety, wellbeing, care or support.

Professionals will work with individuals in a range of ways, which can include undertaking assessments, creating and monitoring plans or sharing information within a multiagency context.

A professional's involvement can be ongoing or relate to a specific service episode, and multiple professionals can work with an individual at any one time from a range of agencies.

How we describe a professional	
Identifier(s)	Any unique identifiers (IDs) associated with the professional
Name	The professional's name
Role	The professional's occupational role (eg. Care worker, GP, etc.)
Status	Active / inactive
Contact	Email addresses / telephone numbers
Related Service	Links to Service object that the professional is related to

Service

Describing a service episode requires describing a service.

An organisation that is involved in the safeguarding or wellbeing of a person. This could be a social care department of a local authority, an A&E department or GP, a school or education authority, or anything else that may support a person or intervene in their lives.

How we describe a service	
Identifier(s)	Any unique identifiers (IDs) associated with the service
Name	The name / aliases of the service
Type	The kind of service (eg. health trust, local authority)
Status	Active / inactive
Address	Physical location(s) of the service
Contact	Email addresses / telephone numbers
Related Professionals	Links to Professionals the Service is related to

Service Episode

A service episode is a bounded period during which an individual receives a defined service, intervention, or package of support from a service or professional. It has a recognisable start and end point, though duration may vary from a single contact to sustained involvement over time.

A service episode represents structured engagement rather than a single interaction, and may include multiple contacts, assessments, reviews, or actions within its timeframe. Individuals may experience multiple concurrent or sequential service episodes across different services or organisations.

How we describe a service episode	
Identifier(s)	Any unique identifiers (IDs) associated with the episode
Type	The kind of service episode
Risk	Risk level / information sensitivity of episode
Subject Person	Links to Persons subject to the episode, with a code for the nature of their involvement
Related Professional & Related Service	Links to Professionals / Services that were involved in the Service Episode, with a code for their involvement
Time Information	Structured data about start, end, frequency
Location Information	String field to describe location of episode

Service Episodes Standard: How explicit should we be about professional involvement?

In our draft: We require a code for the nature of a professional's involvement in the episode. This code is different to the professional's job title – instead of being "emergency paramedic", it might be "first responder to incident". However, we might be saying too much, here, duplicating information and making data collation more complicated. After all, if you have their job role, can't you assume their role in the episode?

The Question: How explicit should we be about a professional's involvement in an episode?

OPTION A

- Minimal, no information, not even a code for involvement. Need to read case notes or contact the professional for details about their involvement
- Most ambiguous option, but limited data input.

OPTION B

- Describe involvement with specified options, according to a code.

OPTION C

- Describe with a free text box.
- Most "customisable" option to describe an involvement in an episode, but increases margin for confusion / error if involvement doesn't line up with expectations from professional's job title.
- What if the text box was optional?

Life Event

A life event is a significant, time-bound occurence in an individual's life that may have implications for their safety, wellbeing or development. They are not inherently positive or negative, but can indicate to safeguarding and wellbeing professionals levels of risk, vulnerability, need or changes in support requirements. Examples of life events in this space could include attendance at A+E, a child being reported as missing or an exclusion from school.

Safeguarding professionals will be interested in the recency of events (when the event most recently happened), frequency (how frequently that incident is occurring), gravity (how serious the incident is when it occurs) and how the event combines with other events and factors in the individual's life to ascertain the support needs.

How we describe a life event	
Identifier(s)	Any unique identifiers (IDs) associated with the event
Type	The kind of life event
Risk	Risk level / information sensitivity of the life event
Subject Person	Links to Persons subject to the event, with a code for the nature of their involvement
Related Professional & Related Service	Links to Professionals / Services that were involved in the life event, with a code for their involvement
Time Information	Structured data about start, end, frequency
Location Information	String field to describe location of event

Service Episodes and Life Events: What does Risk mean?

In our draft: We have a field to describe whether the risk level related to a service episode or life event is low, medium, or high. We haven't actually come to a consensus on how this information should be interpreted, though. Importantly, this is a step towards the metadata level, in some capacity.

The Question: How would you interpret the "risk" related to an event or episode?

OPTION A

- Risk is the level of distress that might be caused by speaking about the event / episode with the subject Person.

OPTION B

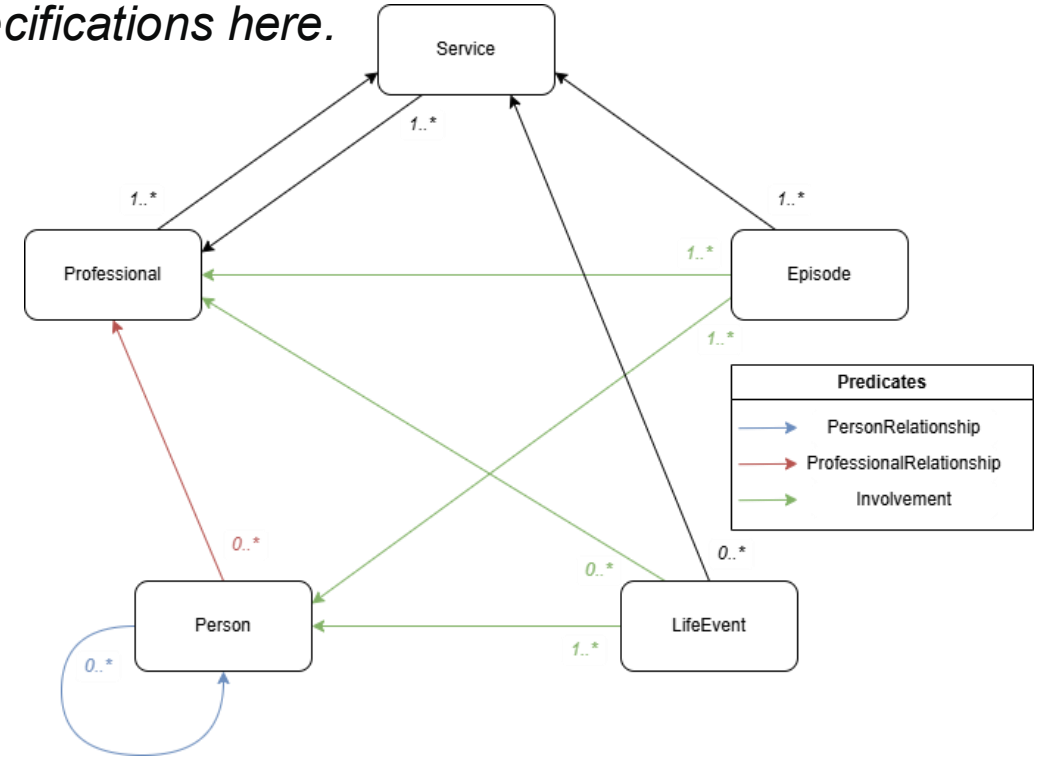
- Risk is the level of information sensitivity related to the event / episode.
- Low risk events can have more information shared than high risk events.

OPTION C

- Risk is too nebulous of a concept for us to tackle / standardise now.

Relationship

To build a full picture of a person's life (and, consequently, plan their safeguarding accordingly), a social worker needs to understand how they are linked to other people, professionals, service episodes, and life events that have been recorded. Each link comes with a predicate according to the specifications here.



How we describe a relationship
Can be either a PersonRelationship, a ProfessionalRelationship, or an Involvement
Each has a code to describe the nature of the relationship / involvement, a code to describe the risk level or information sensitivity of the relationship / involvement, and a code to describe the status of the relationship / involvement

The Association Object

This is the approach used in our `Relationship` standard. It treats the relationship itself as an entity.

- **Source:** The person the record belongs to.
- **Target:** The person being linked to.
- **Predicate:** The type of relationship (from a controlled vocabulary).

Example: If Person A is the "Foster Carer" of Person B:

- Person A's record has a `RelatedPerson` entry.
- `ref`: [Link to Person B]
- `relationship`: "Foster Carer" (This implies A -> B).

Describing relationships between people: How much information is realistic?

In our draft: We want to describe every individual a person has a personal relationship (eg. parent, child, spouse) with via our Person object. In principle this makes sense – the Person object is designed as the minimum amount of information required to identify a person – but requires identifiers, DoB, address, etc. of each connected person.

The Question: Is it realistic to describe, say, an absentee father using the Person specification?

OPTION A

- Use the Person specification to describe every connected person

OPTION B

- Use the Person specification with caveats, adding metadata to point to assumptions or unknown data points
- Increases overall noise and uncertainty within datasets

OPTION C

- Create a RelatedPerson object specification with looser rules
- Describe every connected person with a RelatedPerson object
- Reduces ability to match records and eg. identify where one person is connected to multiple people being supported

Wrapping up

Next steps

- Focusing our R&D on:
  - Identity and Access Management (IDAM)
  - Bulk import and export APIs
  - Refining and prioritising use cases & requirements for Joined-up Care
  - Continuing to build out our social care data model.

Working Group Meetings:

- 26 March 2026

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Thank you.

Contact:

MAIS:

Andrew.newman@theodi.org